



Small margins:

George Russell's retirement at the final turn handed Kimi Antonelli a clear run to victory while opening the door for Lewis Hamilton and Max Verstappen to finish second and third. AP

Battle lines drawn

Kimi Antonelli wins a **hard-fought** race as two former champions snuck onto the podium at the Canadian Grand Prix.

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It has been a stop-start beginning to the F1 season in 2026 but, five races in, the Canadian Grand Prix signified a lights-out moment in what is shaping up to be an intense and likely daredevil fight for the drivers' championship.

The race in Montreal was the first time the two Mercedes cars went all-in in their

intra-team battle for the lead, and boy did they deliver. Starting from the sprint race, the two drivers were at it all weekend, producing moments of fierce competitiveness that even forced the team to intervene with calls for restraint.

The upgrade package brought by the constructors' standings leaders once again confirmed their position as the lead car on the grid. After a surprisingly good getaway that allowed the cars to retain their positions at the